

Getting them **un-stuck**.

When the phone confuses them, panic — not damage — is the real problem. Teach **one reset** and let them recover on their own.

Home is the panic button

It gets out of almost anything.

Home button, or swipe up from the bottom edge.

Teach it until it's automatic.

Lost? Go to the start screen and begin again.

A black screen is just asleep.

One press of the side button wakes it.

Calm the fear first

Fear of breaking it is the real block.

Few tap freely until they believe it.

Let small mistakes happen.

A wrong tap teaches, and harms nothing.

Don't fix it for them.

Walk them there; let their hands do it.

When to restart

Off-and-on fixes most freezes.

Hold the side button to 'slide to power off.'

Show the button combo once.

Face ID phones: side + a volume button.

Then it's a fix they own.

A restart they can do is one less call to you.

Common surprises

App frozen?

Reopen from the start screen — clears most freezes.

Screen sideways?

Turn it upright; it flips back.

Everything huge?

Accidental Zoom — three-finger double-tap.

Pop-up or ad?

Don't tap inside; go to the start screen.

Keep them independent

Leave them the large-print card.

The escape hatches, in their hands.

Resist 'here, let me.'

Doing it for them rebuilds the fear.

Check they can reset alone.

Have them reach it before you go.

Looks alarming, isn't

'Update' or 'verify' pop-up.

Usually a scam ad — close it, never tap in.

The phone seems dead.

Often a flat battery — plug it in and wait.

Helping elders keep their independence — and giving their helpers the tools to do it well.